

Poco F7

A genuine flagship killer

Just three years back, if I had told you there

is a phone priced at Rs 31,999 that packs a 7550mAh battery, is powerful enough to rival most flagships, and comes wrapped in a rugged yet eye-catching design, would you have believed me? Probably not. But wait, by now, you must be wondering why I have listed all the key specs and haven't even mentioned the camera once? Well, that pretty much sums up the story of our new favourite performance mid-ranger, the Poco F7.

I have been using the successor to the Poco F6 for around a week now, and I think it's finally time to tell you everything about it. So here goes my review of the Poco F7.

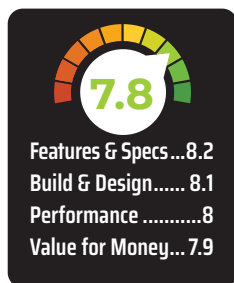
SMUDGE MAGNET, BUT LOOKS GOOD

As I mentioned earlier, the Poco F7 is a rugged smartphone. At Rs 31,999, I genuinely don't think any other brand has launched a phone that offers Gorilla Glass 7i protection on both the front and back, along with an IP69 rating against dust and water. The Poco F7 packs both of these.

Now, coming to the looks, I have the silver variant of the Poco F7 (the one I would recommend to everyone), which sports a unique back panel. It has got some really cool elements: that tiny Snapdragon branding and those green diagonal lines running across the camera bump add a nice touch.

But with great looks comes great maintenance, and no, I am not talking

₹31,999



about money. If you want your Poco F7 to keep looking good, you'll need to carry a microfibre cloth at all times. This phone is a smudge magnet. The silver finish catches so many fingerprints that it kind of steals the charm. Though I would still say go for this colour, it looks fantastic.

Lastly, this phone is quite wide and pretty bulky, weighing over 220 grams. However, honestly, I think that's a fair trade-off when you are getting a power bank-sized battery inside of a smartphone.

A WELL-TUNED DISPLAY

On the display front, the Poco F7 features a 6.83-inch pOLED panel with a 1.5K resolution and a 120Hz refresh rate. Now, while it is not the brightest display in the segment, it doesn't

really hinder usability, be it indoors or outdoors. We recorded a peak brightness of 1780 nits on auto mode, which is not class-leading, but it gets the job done. Despite that, the panel feels fluid and bright enough for everyday use.

Next, this display delivers quite vibrant colours with a solid contrast. The visuals lean slightly towards a more natural side, and this was clearly visible during our testing as well. In Calman's colourimeter test, the Poco F7 scored an average DeltaE of 1.8, which is actually pretty good, and it indicates that the display produces colours that are really close to real-life tones. I feel that it also tries to get most

details on point, because overall I loved watching content on it. And lastly, two things that add to the viewing experience on the Poco F7: Ultra-thin bezels and Dolby Vision support.

TOP-NOTCH PERFORMANCE IN THE SEGMENT

As you all know, the Poco F7 is a performance-centric phone that comes with some impressive specifications: Snapdragon 8s Gen 4, up to 16GB of LPDDR5X RAM, and UFS 4.1 storage. But the real question is, does it actually deliver on those promises?

Well, according to our benchmark tests, the Poco F7 pulled off a seriously good score. I was already impressed with the iQOO Neo 10 when I reviewed it, and now Poco has managed to outshine that as well. Scoring over two million points on AnTuTu at a price of Rs 31,999 is a benchmark in itself. In our testing, flagship devices such as the Galaxy S25 and iPhone 16 have scored lower than the Poco F7 in AnTuTu. So yeah, this one definitely has the firepower of a genuine flagship killer.

But raw power is one thing, but how consistent is that performance in daily use? To test that, I ran the CPU Throttling Test twice: a 15-minute session under moderate load, and another 30-minute session under heavy load.

Turns out, the Poco F7 passed both of the tests like it was a piece of cake. In our 15-minute stress test, the CPU maintained 90% consistency, and the thermals were impressively controlled. The 30-minute stress test did heat things up, but consistency stayed reasonably solid at 82%.

Now, all this was our lab-style testing to prove that this phone can take a left jab, a right jab, and even an uppercut when it comes to performance. But what about real-world usage? That's where gaming performance steps in.

During a 30-minute BGMI session, we noticed that the Poco F7 currently supports only 90 FPS, but it is not capped there. We reached out to the Poco team, and they have confirmed an upcoming OTA update to enable 120